implies that there has to be a permanent ab initio affiliation or grouping of forces to each Theatre, be it in terms of Divisions (Army), Ships (Navy) or Squadrons (Air Force). It is over this fundamental issue that the Theaterization process stalled.

Another aspect that had to be considered was one of operational command and control. For the Army, it ran from the Corps through the Command to Army HQ. The creation of Theatre Commands would effectively mean adding one more link in the chain. At a time when we were trying to shorten the OODA loop below the Corps level by creating IBGs, this seemed counter-intuitive. Two channels of command and control would be required, an operational channel and an administrative channel. The operational channel would follow the Corps–Theatre–COCS route, while the administrative channel would follow the Corps–Command–Army HQ route. In due course of time, the Service HQ would only discharge the Raise–Train–Sustain functions and have an operational role only through the COSC, with the CDS as its permanent chair. The COSC would be in a position to assess emerging threats and re-prioritize the allocation of resources to the Theatres. There was no getting away from the fact that an ab initio allocation of resources to Theatres was an operational imperative. The lessons learnt from the Malayan Campaign and the Fall of Singapore in World War II are both illuminating and instructive, wherein the promised forces never arrived.[16]

A third aspect which was equally important was what happens to the hinterland, which is looked after by the Sub Areas and Area HQ of the Army. What about the secondary role of Internal Security and Aid to Civil Authorities during natural calamities? In the existing set-up, the Area HQ and the Corps HQ both report to the Regional Command, which carries out the necessary coordination. With the creation of Theatre

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